2027 Agent Quick Reference Guide

OTC + Healthy Food + Utilities + Wellness Support



Many UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage plans offer credits that allow members to purchase items, **helping stretch their dollars** even further to support their overall health and wellness.

70K+ retail locations

Flexible shopping options

What's new for 2027?

- **Two cards, more flexibility**

Starting in 2027, members will have a member ID and the UCard. Members will continue to use their UCard to access benefit credits and rewards, and their member ID card when visiting a provider or filling prescriptions. Backed by Mastercard®, the UCard offers added security, reliability, and peace of mind. In addition, qualifying D-SNP members can now use their UCard to **pay covered utilities directly to participating providers** that accept Mastercard.

- **Ongoing retail expansion**

Stores added to our S3 retail network: Costco (membership required), Super 1 Foods, Kinney Drugs, Strack & Van Til, Harris Teeter and Target.

- **Healthy food and utilities qualification is required**

Special Supplemental Benefits for the Chronically Ill (SSBCI) qualified members can use their OTC credit on covered healthy foods and approved utility companies, where the benefit is offered. Eligibility requires one or more qualifying conditions (e.g., who also meet plan criteria indicating they are at high risk for hospitalization and eligible for intensive care coordination). See the SSBCI Quick Reference Guide for further details.

Why UnitedHealthcare?

Shop where you already shop.
All MA Individual plans provide in-store shopping with the UCard, allowing members to use their available OTC benefit while taking advantage of retailer sales and promotions.

Choose from our robust network.
Members can shop at more than 70,000 S3™ retail locations nationwide, including Walmart, Walgreens, Dollar General, Target, and neighborhood stores. Participating stores can be found on Store Finder within the UnitedHealthcare app or member site.

We're here to guide shopping.
With a broad selection of brands and package sizes available within our covered categories, members can choose what works best for them. The UnitedHealthcare app makes shopping easier with the product scanner, helping members quickly check product eligibility. Members can also use their digital UCard barcode for fast checkout.

More choice, less restrictions.
Unlike traditional OTC catalogs, members can shop from a wide range of eligible products at participating retailers. When a category is covered, members can generally choose the brand, size, and product option that best meets their needs.

Convenient online shopping.
Most members can also shop our curated selection online through the app or member site, giving them access to shop from the comfort of home at prices comparable to those available in-store.

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How does it work?

There are three benefit design types. You can visit the Medicare Product Portal for plan-specific coverage.

	 **OTC**	 **OTC & Healthy Food**	 **OTC, Healthy Food, Utilities & Wellness Support**
Plan Eligibility	**Non-SNP[+], I-SNP***	**Most C-SNP, IE-SNP, Some Non-SNP**	**D-SNP** **H4610-001-000 and H4610-002-000 will not offer credits.*
Credit Deposit	The first day of each quarter (1/1, 4/1, 7/1, 10/1)	1st of each month	1st of each month
Credit Expiration	The last day of each quarter (3/31, 6/30, 9/30, 12/31) or annually (based on plan)	The last day of each month	The last day of each month
What's Included	**OTC products** *See more info on page 3*	**OTC products** **Healthy Food** – if SSBCI qualified *See more info on page 3*	**OTC products** **Wellness Support** **Healthy Food** – if SSBCI qualified **Utilities** – if SSBCI qualified *See more info on page 3*
Where Members Shop	• In-store at a participating location • Through the app or member site, or by phone* (except H5253-172-000 and H5253-174-000) • Plans <$40: $20 pre-tax minimum and Walmart-brands-only • Plans $40+: $35 pre-tax minimum	• In-store at a participating location • Through the app or member site, or by phone* ($35 pre-tax minimum)	• In-store at a participating location • Through the app or member site, or by phone* • Plans <$40: $20 pre-tax minimum and Walmart-brands-only • Plans $40+: $35 pre-tax minimum • Pay eligible utility providers that accept Mastercard directly • Buy services through The Helper Bees using the member site or app, learn more on page 4

*Orders are fulfilled by Walmart. + Review plan details for OTC benefits, as not all Non-SNP plans will have OTC.

How does the Utilities benefit work?

Pay eligible utility providers directly if they accept Mastercard.

Eligible Mastercard providers include: Telecommunication Services, Computer Network Services, Utilities: Electric, Gas, Sanitary, Water, Home Fuel: Fuel Oil, Wood, Coal, Government Services: Water and Energy Providers

Use the member site to submit payments and view payment history. Or, visit a Walmart MoneyCenter or Customer Service desk to pay an eligible provider using the UCard, ID, and a copy of the utility bill. Key reminders: Service address must match the member's UHC record, payments may take 3–15 days to post, and any amount exceeding the available benefit balance remains the member's responsibility.

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Benefit Type	What's Covered	What's Not Covered
OTC*	•**Cold, flu & allergy:** allergy medicine, cough drops, decongestants •**Digestive health:** antacids, laxatives, gas relief, nausea remedies and fiber supplements •**Eye and ear care:** eye drops, ear drops, contact lens solution and reading glasses •**First aid:** bandages, gauze, antiseptic wipes, first aid kits •**Home safety aids:** grab bars, non-slip mats, night lights, commodes, shower chairs, bed rails •**Incontinence:** protective underwear, pads, liners, wipes •**Medication support:** pill organizers, pill cutters •**Oral care:** toothbrushes, toothpaste, mouthwash, floss, denture care •**Pain relief:** common oral and topical pain relievers •**Personal care:** hand sanitizer, cotton balls and swabs •**Skin care:** sunscreen, aloe, lip balm, cortisone creams, insect bite relief, and select medicated skin treatments •**Sleep support:** melatonin, nasal strips •**Smoking cessation:** nicotine patches, gum, lozenges •**Testing and monitoring:** blood pressure monitors, thermometers, COVID/flu tests •**Vitamins & minerals:** multivitamins, individual vitamins and minerals •**Women's health:** antifungal treatments, menstrual care items, wipes **Plans with Food:** •**Nutritional Support:** meal replacement drinks and nutritional shakes and bars	•**Alcohol, tobacco, or other controlled products** •**Baby items:** infant medications, diapers, wipes, infant formula •**Cleaning & household supplies:** cleaning sprays, disinfectants, paper towels, toilet paper, laundry detergent, dish soap •**Cosmetics & personal hygiene:** general lotions, anti-aging and anti-wrinkle creams, makeup, perfume, nail care, shampoo, conditioner, deodorant, body wash or soap, facial cleansers, shaving products •**Food & beverages:** nutritional drinks, protein shakes, bars, groceries •**General supplements or homeopathic medications:** fish oil, probiotics, herbal remedies, homeopathic or cannabis products •**Items that may be covered by medical benefits depending on your plan:** diabetic supplies, medical equipment, prescription drugs, hearing devices and batteries. Note: Covered products may vary by plan type.
Healthy Food	•**Beverages**: water, coffee, tea and juice •**Bread & grains**: bread, bagels, buns, cereals, rice and pasta •**Dairy and eggs**: milk, yogurt, cheese and butter •**Fruit and vegetables**: fresh and frozen •**Meat and seafood**: fresh, deli and frozen •**Pantry & prepared foods**: sauces, soups, frozen meals and ready-to-eat items •**Snacks**: crackers, nuts, jerky and popcorn	•**Soft drinks:** soda and energy drinks •**Desserts and sweets:** cake, candy, cookies, ice cream and other desserts •**Baby food and food supplements:** baby food and enteral nutrition products
Home Utilities	•**Energy and home heat:** natural gas, electricity and fuel oil •**Internet service**: home internet •**Phone service:** landline phone •**Water and waste services:** water, sanitation and sewer	•**Automotive fuel:** gas for cars and other vehicles •**Cell phone service and devices:** mobile phone bills, cell phones •**Entertainment services:** cable, streaming services •**Housing costs:** rent, mortgage, property taxes
Wellness Support	•**Caregiver relief:** temporary relief for your primary caregiver through help with tasks of daily living •**In-home services:** help from an attendant with daily needs like bathing, dressing, walking, transfers, feeding, light housekeeping, meal preparation, and laundry •**Weight management counseling:** non-clinical nutritional support to help build healthy habits and manage chronic conditions •**Fitness items:** select fitness items like dumbbells, exercise mats, stationary bikes, and basic activity trackers used primarily for health and fitness tracking are available through the plan website or customer service. *These items are not available in-store.*	•**Sporting goods and apparel:** workout clothing, athletic shoes, sports gear, accessories and smartwatches or other wearable devices with expanded functions such as cellular service, calls or messaging, music or media, or other features. •**Nutritional coaching:** services provided by a personal trainer or registered dietician

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How does D-SNP Wellness Support work?

Wellness support includes certain services, available through The Helper Bees, and select fitness items.

Who are The Helper Bees and how do services work?

The Helper Bees is UnitedHealthcare's network provider for Wellness Support services, connecting eligible members with approved service providers in their area. Members can view pricing upfront, select services in two-hour increments, and use their OTC balance to pay. Once a service is requested, The Helper Bees coordinates scheduling with a qualified provider and the member. Pricing is standardized across service areas.

The Helper Bees D-SNP Member Journey

The Helper Bees®

2027 D-SNP Plan member wants to explore The Helper Bees services.

1 **Shopping**
Member shops available services via their member site or app, or calls the number on the back of their UCard for:

- In-Home Services ($90/2-hours)
- Weight Management Counseling ($70/30-min)
- Caregiver relief ($90/2-hours)

2 **Checkout**
Once the member completes checkout, funds are deducted from their OTC balance in real-time

3 **Service Referral**
The Helper Bees engage one of their trusted third-party service providers

4 **Member Contacted**
The service provider coordinates scheduling with the member

5 **Service Complete**
Service is completed by the service provider

What about fitness items?



2027 D-SNP Plan members will have the option to use their available credits to purchase select fitness items. Fitness items are available through the UnitedHealthcare member site or over the phone only. These items include dumbbells, exercise mats and stationary bikes, fitness wearables and activity trackers. Smartwatches are excluded.

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How will members know about the OTC, Healthy Foods or Utilities benefit?

Members will receive member communications after they sign up for their plan. They can also review their Evidence of Coverage (EOC) for more information on their OTC, Healthy Food and Utilities expiration timeframes and details, which can vary by plan.

How can members check their OTC balances?

Members can visit their UCard Hub on the UnitedHealthcare app or member site to check balances, learn about covered products and services, and find information on how and where to use their UCard.

How will a member know what stores participate to use their credits?

Members can find participating stores with Store Finder and check their credit balance on the UCard Hub on the UnitedHealthcare app or member site.

How will UnitedHealthcare notify members of their SSBCI eligibility?

If we're able to verify a member's SSBCI eligibility, they will receive a confirmation letter in their preferred delivery method. If we can't verify a qualifying condition for the SSBCI benefit, the member will receive a letter letting them know we couldn't verify their qualifying condition and what to expect. Please refer to the SSBCI Quick Reference Guide for more details.

Do benefit credits affect the Housing and Urban Development (HUD) income calculation?

Yes. Under HUD requirements, if Medicare Advantage (MA) supplemental benefits are used to pay for rent or utilities, that support may need to be included in income calculations performed by a housing provider or Public Housing Agency (PHA). Credit used for over-the-counter (OTC) items, healthy food, wellness support, home internet or phone services, and unused benefit credit are not counted as income. If there are questions, please contact the member's local housing authority or HUD office for assistance. For full details, see the HUD guidance: https://www.huduser.gov/portal//portal/sites/default/files/pdf/FAQ-Medicare-Advantage-Supplemental-Benefits.pdf.

How can members request utility spend information for my HUD income calculation?

Members can contact us at the number listed on their UnitedHealthcare UCard.

Do benefit credits affect Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) eligibility?

No. Supplemental benefits do not count as income for SNAP purposes. For more details, see the USDA guidance: https://www.fns.usda.gov/snap/medicare-advantage-supplemental-benefits-excluded-income.

If there are questions about SNAP eligibility, please contact the member's local SNAP office for assistance.

Why aren't there printed OTC catalogs?

UCard provides members with more flexibility and choice than a traditional OTC catalog. Instead of selecting from a pre-defined catalog assortment, members can shop from a broader range of eligible products at participating retailers, including different brands, package sizes, and product options – allowing members to choose the products that best meet their needs while taking advantage of available in-store promotions and savings.

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How can you support UnitedHealthcare members?

- **Encourage** members to use the UnitedHealthcare app or member site. These were developed to help make it easy for members to navigate their benefits, such as learning about covered items.
- **Direct** members to the UCard Hub to check their balance, find a store and explore informative videos. These videos are designed to help members get familiar with their UCard such as how to find covered OTC items or manage their card.
- **Support** questions on SSBCI and help guide member through the qualification process or knowing what they can use their benefit to purchase.
- **Prepare** members to make the most of their shopping trip, have them:
  - Verify their UCard is active or their digital barcode is available.
  - Check balance and eligible items before heading to the store.
  - Try the product scanner in the UnitedHealthcare app to help make in-store shopping even easier.
  - Take advantage of one-stop convenience for OTC purchases, prescriptions, and vision services at participating retailers.

Agent resources to explore!

- Explore the 2027 OTC, Healthy Foods, and Utilities for Medicare Advantage Plans national webinar. This webinar will cover the fundamentals of this benefit, including key features, the value proposition, the member experience, and marketing strategies.
- Learn more about the UCard in our 2027 UCard Experience for Medicare Advantage Plans national webinar and download the 2027 UCard QRG found on Jarvis.
- Check out the Evidence of Coverage (EOC) for additional information on the 2027 UnitedHealthcare D-SNP offerings. The EOC can be found in the Sales Materials Portal.
- Visit UnitedHealthcare's Medicare & Retirement YouTube channel for consumer-friendly educational videos. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9pQxp3Y5BoU
- Help members locate a nearby network retailer by using the Store Finder tool in Jarvis.

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